Transport Policy

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Transport Policy

Policy Title: Transport Policy

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, residents, contractors, volunteers, and visitors at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to ensuring that any transport provided or arranged for residents is safe, reliable, and suited to their needs. Transport may be required for healthcare appointments, social outings, emergencies, or personal visits.

We aim to:

- Ensure residents' safety and dignity during all journeys
- Comply with relevant health, safety, and safeguarding legislation
- Provide accessible transport that meets individual needs
- Promote independence while supporting wellbeing and social engagement

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Outline safe procedures for transporting residents
- Define responsibilities of staff, drivers, and escorts
- Ensure vehicles are maintained, insured, and legally compliant
- Provide guidance on risk assessment and emergency procedures during transport

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All transport organised by [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], including staff-driven vehicles, contracted transport services, and taxis
- All residents using transport for medical, social, or personal reasons
- Staff and volunteers accompanying or supporting residents during travel

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures transport arrangements comply with safety and legal requirements
- Maintains records of vehicle insurance, MOT, servicing, and driver checks
- Oversees risk assessments for transport activities

Drivers (Staff or Contractors):

- Must hold a valid driving licence suitable for the vehicle used
- Must complete regular driver checks, including DBS and medical fitness (if required)
- Must ensure vehicles are safe, roadworthy, and suitable for passengers before each journey

Escorts/Accompanying Staff:

- Responsible for supporting residents during travel
- Must ensure seatbelts, wheelchair restraints, and safety equipment are correctly used
- Must follow emergency procedures if incidents occur during transport

Residents and Families:

- Informed of transport procedures and safety rules
- Encouraged to share relevant health and mobility needs in advance

5. Transport Safety Procedures

- All residents will be risk assessed before travel to ensure transport meets their needs (e.g., wheelchair access, oxygen, mobility aids).
- Seatbelts must be worn at all times unless medically exempt.
- Wheelchairs must be secured using approved restraint systems.
- Staff must assist residents with embarking/disembarking safely.
- First aid kits and fire extinguishers will be available in care home vehicles.
- Emergency contact details must be carried during all journeys.

6. Vehicle Standards

- Vehicles must be roadworthy, regularly serviced, and maintained according to manufacturer guidelines.
- Insurance, MOT, and tax records must be up to date.
- Vehicles must be cleaned regularly, with infection prevention measures in place.
- Accessibility features (ramps, lifts, hoists) must be tested and maintained.

7. Types of Transport

7.1 Care Home Vehicles

- Driven only by authorised, trained staff.
- Used for group outings, medical appointments, or individual transport as required.

7.2 External Transport Providers

- Only approved and reputable providers may be used (e.g., wheelchair-access taxis, ambulance services).
- Providers must show evidence of insurance, safety checks, and staff vetting.

7.3 Emergency Transport

- In emergencies, NHS ambulance services will be contacted immediately.
- Staff must follow the Emergency/Business Continuity Policy.

8. Safeguarding and Confidentiality

- Residents will be supervised appropriately during journeys.
- Confidential conversations or care details must not be discussed publicly in vehicles.
- Staff must ensure residents are never left alone in vehicles.

9. Training and Awareness

- Drivers and escorts will receive training in passenger safety, safeguarding, and first aid.
- Staff will be trained in the correct use of wheelchair restraints, lifts, and accessibility equipment.

10. Monitoring and Review

- Transport logs will be maintained for all journeys (date, time, driver, passengers, destination).
- Vehicle safety checks must be recorded before use.
- Incidents, near-misses, or breakdowns must be reported and reviewed.
- Policy effectiveness will be reviewed annually or following an incident.

11. References

- Road Traffic Act 1988
- Highway Code
- Health and Safety at Work Act 1974
- Care Quality Commission (CQC) Fundamental Standards
- Department for Transport Accessibility Guidance

12. Related Policies

- Health and Safety Policy
- Risk Assessment Policy
- Business Continuity & Emergency Planning Policy
- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Infection Prevention & Control Policy

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